

Project Assessment

Minimum requirements to pass the project

The project pass mark for BEng undergraduate students is 40% and for MEng undergraduate students is 50%.

To pass the project, you must:

1. Submit an **interim report**, judged by your supervisor and second marker to be of an acceptable standard.
2. Submit a **final report**, judged by your supervisor and second marker to be of an acceptable standard.
3. Complete a **project presentation** at a scheduled date of time, judged by an assessment team to be of an acceptable standard.

The overall level of project achievement (the final grade) is determined through academic judgement by an assessment team with input from the project supervisor and second marker. The marks awarded by individual assessment teams are further cross checked and moderated to assure fairness and consistency of marking, with the process checked by external examiners. All marks are awarded based on academic judgement.

MEng Project Assessment Criteria

MEng level projects are expected to be approached as research projects. This means that they should include sound background research, a solid implementation or equivalent piece of theoretical work, and a thorough evaluation of the project's output in both absolute and relative terms. The very best MEng projects invariably cover some new ground, for example by developing a complex application which does not already exist, or by enhancing some existing application or method to improve its functionality, performance.

A straightforward implementation project is acceptable, but it is unlikely to gain high marks at MEng level, regardless of how well it is done. Projects which are predominantly extended literature reviews are not acceptable. These would need to be backed up by experimentation, implementation, or theoretical analysis.

It can be valuable to publish a research paper alongside your project, or to present at a suitable conference. This is not directly taken into account during assessment as not all students are

afforded this opportunity, but this can be a useful way for you to demonstrate that there is wider interest in your work.

Assessment Process

Marks are determined by academic judgement. The descriptors provide an indication of likely attributes and typical minimal standards to be reached for a mark to be determined in a grade band. marking bands, but is meant as guidance for markers and is not intended to be prescriptive.

Note that JMC students are assessed against the same criteria as Computing and EIE students, but the volume of work produced is expected to be slightly lower to take into account the different module weightings of the projects.

Framing of Research Problem (15%)

This considers how well a suitable research question or problem has been identified, and how clearly this has been motivated through the engagement with verifiable academic research.

Band	Descriptor
0–39%	Problem is unclear, trivial, or fundamentally inappropriate for a final-year MEng project. Little or no explicit research question or objectives. Minimal or incorrect engagement with relevant computing/theoretical literature. Major misunderstandings of context; critical work is missing or misinterpreted.
40–49%	Problem is stated in very general terms, with weak or vague research question(s). Objectives may be incomplete or poorly aligned with the work done. Literature coverage is narrow, dated, or mostly descriptive; key sources are missing; limited understanding of the state of the art.
50–59%	Problem is broadly appropriate but framed somewhat loosely or with limited precision. Research question and objectives are present but could be clearer or better justified. Literature review covers some relevant work and shows basic understanding, but there are gaps (e.g. recent or domain-specific work). Limited critical comparison of approaches.
60–69%	Problem is clearly defined and suitable in scope and difficulty for an MEng project. Research question(s) and objectives are explicit, coherent, and aligned with the work undertaken. Literature engagement is reasonably broad and up-to-date, drawing on

	appropriate technical or theoretical sources. Some critical insight into how the project relates to existing work and where it fits in the wider field.
70–84%	Problem is sharply framed, well motivated, and demonstrates strong awareness of disciplinary context (e.g. a clear gap, tension, or opportunity in the computing literature). Research question(s) are precise, ambitious yet realistic. Literature engagement is wide and selective, with clear critical analysis and synthesis; the student articulates how their work advances, challenges, or combines prior approaches.
85%+	Problem framing is exceptionally strong and original, showing deep understanding of the field and a compelling justification for the work (e.g. clearly articulated research gap or novel integration of areas). Research question(s) are elegantly formulated and could credibly underpin a publishable study. Literature engagement is sophisticated, integrative, and insightful, demonstrating mastery of the area and shaping the project's direction in a highly effective way.

Execution and Technical Quality (50%)

This asks how well a challenging problem has been addressed, how far research and technical work has been completed using clear and valid methodologies, and if originality and novelty have been demonstrated as appropriate.

Band	Descriptor
0–39%	Very limited or inappropriate methodology; major flaws in design, implementation, analysis, or proofs. Little evidence of systematic work. Technical component (software, experiments, models, or theory) is incomplete, non-functional, or incorrect. Work is not reproducible or verifiable from the report. Minimal originality.
40–49%	Some relevant technical work, but methods are weakly justified or poorly executed. Implementation or theoretical development is basic, fragile, or contains significant errors. Limited testing, evaluation, or validation. Reproducibility is low (missing details, unclear procedures). Originality is minimal and largely derivative.
50–59%	A reasonable methodology is used, but justification and rigor are uneven. Technical work meets the minimum expected level for a final-year MEng project but the problem may appear simple, achievement may be modest in scope or have some unresolved issues (bugs, incomplete proofs, shallow experimentation). Reproducibility is possible but requires

	assumptions or guesswork. Some signs of originality (e.g. a non-trivial combination of techniques) but generally incremental.
60 – 69 %	Methodology is appropriate, clearly explained, and generally well justified. Technical work (implementation, experiments, or theoretical contribution) is substantial and mostly correct, showing solid competence. Adequate testing/validation (e.g. systematic experiments, benchmarks, or proof sketches) is presented. The report provides enough detail for an informed reader to reproduce the main results. Clear evidence of originality in approach, design choices, or problem tackled.
70 – 84 %	Methodology shows strong design and critical justification, selecting and adapting techniques with insight. Technical work is of high quality and scope: robust implementation or rigorous theoretical development, with few errors and clear engineering or analytical decisions. Evaluation is thorough and carefully designed. Reproducibility is high, with well-documented methods, data, and/or code structure. Demonstrates clear innovation or non-trivial novelty in method, architecture, model, or theoretical contribution.
85 %+	Execution is exemplary. Methodology is sophisticated and could credibly support publication (e.g. advanced experimental design, non-trivial proofs, or a novel systems architecture). Technical contribution is impressive in depth and/or breadth, showing excellent engineering or theoretical skill. Evaluation is rigorous, well controlled, and anticipates possible objections. The work is highly reproducible, with precise specifications and documentation. Originality is striking: the project advances the state of the art, or offers a genuinely novel perspective or result for the level.

Evaluation and Reflection (20%)

This considers the broader potential impact of the project, its relationship to the wider research field, and how you have critically assessed this.

Band	Descriptor
0– 39 %	Very little or no evaluation of results or theoretical claims. Minimal reflection on limitations, risks, or validity. Contribution is unclear or overstated. No consideration of broader impact, or future work.
40– 49 %	Evaluation is superficial, largely descriptive, or relies on anecdotal evidence. Limited critical engagement with results (e.g. merely restating graphs/tables). Contribution is weakly articulated. Broader impacts are largely ignored or mentioned only in passing.

50–59%	Some appropriate evaluation, but with gaps (e.g. limited metrics, small or unrepresentative datasets, incomplete exploration of cases). Reflection exists but is mostly basic (lists limitations without deeper analysis). Contribution is identifiable but not fully justified. Broader impact and related issues such as ethics are noted but treated briefly.
60–69%	Results or theoretical claims are evaluated using reasonable and relevant criteria (metrics, comparisons, case studies, or analytical arguments). The student reflects meaningfully on strengths, limitations, and possible sources of error or bias. Contribution to the field or application domain is clearly stated and plausibly supported. Broader impact, including ethical, social, or sustainability considerations where relevant, is discussed in a thoughtful way.
70–84%	Evaluation is thorough and well structured, using appropriate quantitative and/or qualitative methods (or rigorous argumentation for theory). The student critically interrogates their own work, identifying trade-offs, threats to validity, and alternative explanations. Contribution is convincingly situated within the wider field (e.g. comparison with baselines, related systems, or theoretical results). Broader impact is explored with insight, potentially including responsible innovation, user implications, or long-term risks/benefits.
85%+	Evaluation and reflection are of an exceptional standard, comparable to strong research publications. The student demonstrates mature, self-critical judgement, integrating multiple forms of evidence or arguments. Contribution is articulated with nuance and realism, including clarity on what does <i>not</i> generalise. Broader impact is analysed in depth, linking technical choices to ethical, societal, or disciplinary consequences in a sophisticated way.

Communication of Ideas (15%)

This assessed the structure of the finished report, language clarity, and how well the project has been completed in compliance with academic integrity expectations. Note that unacceptable GenAI use and serious breaches of academic integrity are likely to lead to a mark in the 0-39% band regardless of the overall quality of the project - and may also be referred for an academic misconduct investigation.

Band	Descriptor
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0–39%	Report is very poorly structured or incomplete; hard to follow. Frequent language errors impede understanding. Many figures, tables, or equations are unclear or missing. Use of GenAI is undeclared, clearly breaches policy, or strongly suggests over-reliance on AI-generated content. Referencing is absent, highly inaccurate, or suggests plagiarism.
40–49%	Basic structure (introduction, methods, results, conclusion) is present but weakly organised or unbalanced. Language is understandable but contains frequent errors, colloquialisms, or ambiguity. Limited signposting, weak figure/table labelling. GenAI use may be mentioned but not clearly documented or critically managed. Referencing style is inconsistent or incomplete, with missing citations or unclear sources. A report that exceeds the page limit cannot obtain a mark beyond this band.
50–59%	Overall structure is reasonable and within page limits but may have some repetition, missing transitions, or uneven sections. Language is generally clear but with noticeable stylistic or grammatical issues. Visuals and mathematical notation are present but not always well integrated or explained. GenAI usage is within acceptable boundaries but may be described only briefly; limited evidence of critical oversight. Referencing is mostly correct but inconsistent in places (minor omissions, formatting issues).
60–69%	Report is clearly structured within the page limit with a logical flow. Sections are well signposted and appropriately balanced. Language is clear, formal, and mostly free of errors. Figures, tables, code snippets, and/or maths are well presented and explained. GenAI use (if any) is clearly disclosed, appropriately limited (e.g. for idea generation, proofreading, or coding assistance), and subject to human review; the student remains the clear author of the work. Referencing is accurate and consistent, using a recognised style; sources are properly cited in text and in the reference list.
70–84%	Writing is polished, concise, and engaging, with excellent structure and coherence within the page limits. Technical and theoretical explanations are clear to an appropriate expert or advanced student audience. Visuals and notation are well chosen, professional, and enhance understanding. GenAI usage is transparently documented and critically reflected upon (e.g. noting limitations, checks, or how AI suggestions were adapted). Referencing is meticulous and well integrated, demonstrating good scholarly practice throughout.

85%+	Communication is outstanding and publication-ready in terms of clarity, organisation, and style. Complex ideas are explained accessibly without loss of rigour. Visual and mathematical presentation is exemplary. GenAI use (if any) is exemplary in its transparency, ethical awareness, and critical management, potentially serving as a model for responsible use. Referencing is of a professional standard, showing deep engagement with sources and impeccable consistency.
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BEng Project Assessment Criteria

The assessment for BEng projects is largely equivalent to the MEng version, but this takes into account the lower academic level of the project, that students have not studied as many advanced modules or attended a formal placement, and that the weighting for BEng projects is lower than it is for MEng projects.

BEng students can choose to work on a research focused project, but they can also instead opt to focus on engineering a solid solution to a technical problem. BEng students are still expected to incorporate relevant existing ideas, to refer to and build upon relevant academic research, and to suitably evaluate the work they have completed.

Assessment Process

Marks are determined by academic judgement. The descriptors provide an indication of likely attributes and typical minimal standards to be reached for a mark to be determined in a grade band. marking bands, but is meant as guidance for markers and is not intended to be prescriptive.

Note that JMC students are assessed against the same criteria as Computing and EIE students, but the volume of work produced is expected to be slightly lower to take into account the different module weightings of the projects.

Framing of Technical or Research Problem (15%)

This considers how well a suitable technical problem or research problem has been identified, and how clearly this has been motivated through the engagement with relevant source materials.

Band	Descriptor
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0–39%	Problem is unclear, trivial, or fundamentally inappropriate for a final-year BEng project. Little or no explicit aims or objectives. Minimal or incorrect engagement with relevant computing/theoretical sources. Major misunderstandings of context; critical work is missing or misinterpreted.
40–49%	Problem is stated in weak or vague terms. Objectives may be incomplete or poorly aligned with the work done. Background coverage is narrow, dated, or mostly descriptive; key sources are missing; limited understanding of the state of the art.
50–59%	Problem is broadly appropriate but framed somewhat loosely or with limited precision. Background review covers some relevant work and shows basic understanding, but there are gaps (e.g. recent or domain-specific work). Limited critical comparison of approaches.
60–69%	Problem is clearly defined and suitable in scope and difficulty for an BEng project. Research or technical objectives are explicit, coherent, and aligned with the work undertaken. Literature engagement is reasonably broad and up-to-date, drawing on appropriate technical or theoretical sources. Some critical insight into how the project relates to existing work and where it fits in the wider field.
70–84%	Problem is sharply framed, well motivated, and demonstrates strong awareness of disciplinary context (e.g. a clear gap, tension, or opportunity in the computing literature) or a clearly articulated engineering/design challenge grounded in prior work. Objectives are precise, ambitious yet realistic. Literature engagement is wide and selective, with clear critical analysis and synthesis; the student articulates how their work draws on, combines, or (where appropriate) extends prior approaches.
85%+	Problem framing is exceptionally strong and original, showing deep understanding of the field and a compelling justification for the work (e.g. clearly articulated research gap or novel integration of areas). Objectives are elegantly formulated and could credibly underpin a publishable study or chapter in an advanced textbook. Literature engagement is sophisticated, integrative, and insightful, demonstrating mastery of the area and shaping the project's direction in a highly effective way.

Execution and Technical Quality (50%)

This asks how well appropriate research and/or engineering methodologies have been applied, with original ideas tried and tested as appropriate, and solid work produced.

Band	Descriptor
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0–39%	Very limited or inappropriate methodology; major flaws in design, implementation, analysis, or proofs. Little evidence of systematic work. Technical component (software, experiments, models, or theory) is incomplete, non-functional, or incorrect. Work is not reproducible or verifiable from the report. Minimal originality.
40–49%	Some relevant technical work, but this may be basic, or methods may be weakly justified or poorly executed. Technical work meets the minimum expected level for a final-year BEng project. Limited testing, evaluation, or validation. Reproducibility is low (missing details, unclear procedures).
50–59%	A reasonable methodology is used, but justification and rigor are uneven. The problem may appear simple, achievement may be modest in scope or have some unresolved issues (bugs, incomplete proofs, shallow experimentation). Reproducibility is possible but requires assumptions or guesswork. Few signs of originality.
60–69%	Methodology is appropriate, clearly explained, and generally well justified. Technical work (implementation, experiments, or theoretical contribution) is substantial and mostly correct, showing solid competence. Adequate testing/validation (e.g. systematic experiments, benchmarks, or proof sketches) is presented. The report provides enough detail for an informed reader to reproduce the main results. There may be some originality in approach or design, or this may be a solid, well-engineered application of existing methods, tools, or theories.
70–84%	Methodology shows strong design and critical justification, selecting and adapting techniques with insight. Technical work is of high quality and scope: robust implementation or rigorous theoretical development, with few errors and clear engineering or analytical decisions. Evaluation is thorough and carefully designed. Reproducibility is high, with well-documented methods, data, and/or code structure. Either demonstrates clear innovation or non-trivial novelty in method, architecture, model, or theoretical contribution, or delivers an outstanding piece of technical engineering that applies existing ideas with exceptional care, depth, and justification.

85%+	Execution is exemplary. Methodology is sophisticated and could credibly support publication (e.g. advanced experimental design, non-trivial proofs, or a novel systems architecture). Technical contribution is impressive in depth and/or breadth, showing excellent engineering or theoretical skill. Evaluation is rigorous, well controlled, and anticipates possible objections. The work is highly reproducible, with precise specifications and documentation. Originality and/or engineering achievement are striking: the project either advances the state of the art, offers a genuinely novel perspective or result, or delivers a level of technical quality and robustness that is exceptional.
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Evaluation and Reflection (20%)

This considers the broader potential impact of the project, its relationship to the wider field or application domain, and how you have critically assessed this.

Band	Descriptor
0–39%	Very little or no evaluation of results or theoretical claims. Minimal reflection on limitations, risks, or validity. Contribution is unclear or overstated. No consideration of broader impact, or future work.
40–49%	Evaluation is superficial, largely descriptive, or relies on anecdotal evidence. Limited critical engagement with results (e.g. merely restating graphs/tables). Contribution is weakly articulated. Broader impacts are largely ignored or mentioned only in passing.
50–59%	Some appropriate evaluation, but with gaps (e.g. limited metrics, small or unrepresentative datasets, incomplete exploration of cases). Reflection exists but is mostly basic (lists limitations without deeper analysis). Contribution is identifiable but not fully justified. Broader impact and related issues such as ethics are noted but treated briefly.
60–69%	Results or theoretical claims are evaluated using reasonable and relevant criteria (metrics, comparisons, case studies, or analytical arguments). The student reflects meaningfully on strengths, limitations, and possible sources of error or bias. Contribution to the field, application domain, or engineering practice is clearly stated and plausibly supported (e.g. improved solution to a known problem, better understanding of trade-offs, or clearer comparison of alternatives). Broader impact, including ethical, social, or sustainability considerations where relevant, is discussed in a thoughtful way.
70–84%	Evaluation is thorough and well structured, using appropriate quantitative and/or qualitative methods (or rigorous argumentation for theory). The student critically

%	interrogates their own work, identifying trade-offs, threats to validity, and alternative explanations. Contribution is convincingly situated within the wider field (e.g. comparison with baselines, related systems, or theoretical results). Broader impact is explored with insight, potentially including responsible innovation, user implications, or long-term risks/benefits.
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40– 49%	Basic structure (introduction, methods, results, conclusion) is present but weakly organised or unbalanced. Language is understandable but contains frequent errors, colloquialisms, or ambiguity. Limited signposting, weak figure/table labelling. GenAI use may be mentioned but not clearly documented or critically managed. Referencing style is inconsistent or incomplete, with missing citations or unclear sources. A report that exceeds the page limit cannot obtain a mark beyond this band.
50– 59%	Overall structure is reasonable and within page limits but may have some repetition, missing transitions, or uneven sections. Language is generally clear but with noticeable stylistic or grammatical issues. Visuals and mathematical notation are present but not always well integrated or explained. GenAI usage is within acceptable boundaries but

	may be described only briefly; limited evidence of critical oversight. Referencing is mostly correct but inconsistent in places (minor omissions, formatting issues).
60– 69%	Report is clearly structured within the page limit with a logical flow. Sections are well signposted and appropriately balanced. Language is clear, formal, and mostly free of errors. Figures, tables, code snippets, and/or maths are well presented and explained. GenAI use (if any) is clearly disclosed, appropriately limited (e.g. for idea generation, proofreading, or coding assistance), and subject to human review; the student remains the clear author of the work. Referencing is accurate and consistent, using a recognised style; sources are properly cited in text and in the reference list.
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